



>>the industry is in a state of transition >>

>>Nikhil Soman, Founder, Playblazer

When and how did you start PlayBlazer?

PlayBlazer is actually my second venture after Dialify (a pioneer in audio gaming) and the third in gaming. After being involved in the gaming industry through Zapak, I came to realise that game developers need to spend large amounts of time and resources – monetary as well as human – while developing games. A large part of this investment goes in processes that are repeated in every studio – particularly for multiplayer games. PlayBlazer was born as a solution to this problem.

What are requirements of a game development studio?

We believe the gaming industry is currently in a state of transition. This transition is from single-player to multiplayer games, while social mechanics are a key indicator of how important it is to have games where players can collaborate as well as compete. Farmville like games were the earliest collaborative gameplay experiences, and a Zynga Poker or Clash of Clans (both huge grossers in terms of ARPAU).

What are the challenges faced by game developers in India?

Game development is generally very complex and difficult, especially in terms of scale and concurrency requirements. This coupled with the creative requirements makes it even more challenging. In India and everywhere else in the world, only very large studios can afford the capital expenses for infrastructure – thus, the larger studios become larger while the smaller studios remain small due to lack of investment. >

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